

Case Study

Name	Mrs D
DOB	03/12/70
Occupation	Account director
Policy Definition	Rheumatoid arthritis – chronic and severe A definite diagnosis of rheumatoid arthritis by a Consultant Rheumatologist resulting in all of the following: ▪ There must be morning stiffness in the affected joints of at least one-hour duration ▪ There must be arthritis of at least 3 joint groups with soft tissue swelling or fluid observed by a physician ▪ The arthritis must involve at least one of the following sites: wrists or ankles, hands and fingers, feet and toes ▪ There must be symmetrical arthritis ▪ There must be subcutaneous nodules ▪ There must be radiographic changes typical of rheumatoid arthritis
Medical Evidence	Saw GP Aug 2012 arthralgia, getting left shoulder pain for 2 months and now pain in right wrist and knee for last month. Blood tests and referred for physio. FBC and ESR normal Saw GP 23/09/13 with perceived left wrist strain, still some pain in right wrist and knee and occasionally left knee, after 2 months of medication referred to Rheumatology Diagnosis of RA confirmed Feb 2014. Consultant report attached
Questions	Do you feel you have enough evidence to make a decision on this claim? If yes, are you satisfied that the definition has been fulfilled? If not, what further information would you ask for? Any further thoughts?

Consultant Rheumatologist

The HCF Rheumatology Practice Ltd

Dear Ms Assessor,

Mrs D

DOB: 03.12.70

Many thanks for your letter in relation to my patient. I note that you require information from her medical records in connection with her diagnosis and cover for critical illness. I have already contacted your team and indicated that not all the information is available from her records, but I believe that you wish me to restrict myself to comments on the basis of her notes. I have extracted the following information from the records:

- The exact diagnosis is seropositive rheumatoid arthritis
- The diagnosis was established in February 2014. The patient was made aware of the diagnosis at that time.
- It was confirmed that morning stiffness was in excess of one hour and that all groups are involved with soft tissue swelling.
- On examination all joints of the hands, fingers, wrists and feet are affected to some degree.
- There is no evidence of subcutaneous nodules and no plain film changes associated with rheumatoid arthritis but the MRI scan has identified synovitis in both hands, more pronounced on the right.

I confirm that I am her treating Consultant Rheumatologist. Other than her General Practitioner I am not aware of any other Medical Practitioners involved in her management.

Yours sincerely

Mr Rheumatologist